Lancashire at the end of the 2018 season and is developing a coaching career.

On a personal level, that match was one of my most memorable experiences. Being an Ashes-winning captain is very special. It meant everything to share it with Alice and my parents. I don't care about the relative merits of that Australian team; they never go quietly. Who, for instance, remembers the weakness of the side beaten by Mike Gatting's 'can't bat, can't bowl, can't field' England in 1986–87?

It's in the book, part of the bloodline.

I had set up the series by telling the team that it was their chance to enter folklore and link their names to an historic rivalry. We didn't want an open-topped bus parade and the keys to the Downing Street drinks cabinet, but I find it puzzling that our 2013 win should be regarded as the forgotten Ashes. The sudden familiarity of victory, after a quarter-century of Australian domination, worked against us.

Of course, there is an element of remorse. It is part of a captain's responsibility to look after people and I felt for Simon on a human level. I occasionally wonder what he thinks of those celebratory pictures, with the champagne spraying and the tinsel cascading, where I'm holding up a replica Ashes urn taken from the Lord's shop.

The original artefact, of course, is far too fragile to be entrusted to a bunch of cricketers eager to get on the sauce. It even had its own first-class seat when flown to Australia, for only the second time, in 2006. The romance it represented, as an old perfume bottle given to England captain Ivo Bligh in 1882 by Lady Clark after defeat to Australia prompted a mock obituary of English cricket, didn't survive our celebrations. That night ended, infamously, with Pee-gate and online images of myself and Matty, still in our kit, attempting to flag down a London bus. I was carrying my England blazer on a hanger; it is one of my favourite photos.

I deeply regret the urination on the square that night. It was not meant to be disrespectful; it was simply a case of a group of young guys being carried away by the moment. The characteristics of a successful team, in our case intensity, repeatability, self-assurance and an insularity tinged with arrogance, can mutate, and accelerate its downfall.

International sport is cyclical, and we weren't alone in underestimating the underlying issues. It happens to the best. Australia, under the coaching influence of Darren Lehmann, were brash, verbally aggressive and pushed